

Government approves Make in India defence policy

Guidelines for the defence strategic partnership model have been finally approved by the Central government. The model offers various incentives to domestic private and foreign firms, if they manufacture for India's defence forces locally.

The decision was taken at a meeting of Defence Acquisition Council, led by Nirmala Sitharaman, minister of defence. The first project to be launched will be for 111 armed light naval utility twin-engine helicopters,

worth approximately ₹ 210 billion. The aim of the strategic partnership model is to revive the defence industrial system and improve the capabilities within the private sector to design, manufacture and develop complex weapon systems for the future needs of the armed forces.

According to industry sources, 16 helicopters would be procured from a foreign vendor and the remaining 95 will be built in India by an Indian partner, through joint ventures and technology transfers.

IESA, KOTRA sign MoU for collaboration in the ESDM industry

The electronic system design and manufacturing (ESDM) industry is accelerating towards self-reliance to reduce its import bill. To further boost the electronics and semiconductor industry, India Electronics & Semiconductor Association (IESA) signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Korea Trade Investment Promotion Agency (KOTRA).

The collaboration is intended to establish a business platform to pro-

mote and enhance business cooperation in the electronics and semiconductor industry between the two countries. The MoU was signed by Anil Kumar Muniswamy, chairman, IESA and Dr Pyung Oh Kwon, president, KOTRA. Both IESA and KOTRA will share information relating to the electronics and semiconductor industry and promote a value chain for production, R&D, design, marketing, exchange of manpower and so on.

Tech Mahindra to roll out 5G pilot projects this month

Tech Mahindra expects to launch about five pilot projects on 5G services by this month and execute big projects on the new-generation network from next financial year onwards, as reported by *Economic Times*. A senior official from the company had earlier said that it had set up an innovation lab powered by Intel architecture to accelerate 5G roll out in India.

The Centre constituted a high-level committee last year, comprising secretaries of the telecom depart-

ment, IT and electronics ministry and science and technology department, to work out the vision, mission and goals for India's 5G ambitions and prepare a road map and action plan for the same. Telecom industry body Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI) said, auction of spectrum for 5G services should happen only around the second half of 2019 as it would offer telcos better visibility into market dynamics and potential revenue streams of next-generation mobile services.

On The Move

Hemant Tiwari joins Hitachi Vantara as GM, India

Hitachi Vantara, a wholly-owned subsidiary of Hitachi, has named Hemant Tiwari as vice president and general manager (GM) for India. He will lead Hitachi Vantara's business and operations in India with a focus on growing the overall business, building up the partner ecosystem and accelerating expansion of the company's revenue and market share in India.

Accenture names Gene Renzik as chief strategy officer

Accenture has appointed Gene Renzik as chief strategy officer. He takes over from Omar Abbosh, who was named group chief executive officer - communications, media and technology.

Infosys hires John Gikopoulos as new global head - AI and automation

Former IP Soft director John Gikopoulos has joined Infosys as global head of artificial intelligence (AI) and automation business at its consulting unit, as the IT company bets big on the two technologies to drive its business.

Reliance Jio and Bharti Airtel CTOs resign

Chief technology officers (CTOs) of Reliance Jio and Bharti Airtel have resigned from their respective companies. Jagbir Singh joined Reliance Jio before the soft launch of 4G services. Prior to this, he worked with Samsung and Airtel.

Shyam Prabhakar Mardikar was serving as CTO of Airtel's mobile network since January 2017, after being with Airtel since August 2012. This was his second stint with Airtel. Earlier, he was with the telecom major from 2001 to 2010, after quitting his job at Department of Telecom.

HCL Technologies CFO Anil Chanana to retire in December

HCL Technologies announced that its chief financial officer (CFO) Anil Chanana will retire in December this year. He has been with HCL for more than 35 years.